

Exercise 1

Look at these 3 headlines that have been in the news a lot lately. Discuss with a partner:

- Which of these do you already know something about? What can you tell your partner?
- Why do you think these stories are getting so much attention online?
- Which one do you find most interesting? Why?

STYLE

Rhode, Hailey Bieber's Beauty Brand, Sells in Billion-Dollar Deal

E.L.F. Beauty acquired Mrs. Bieber's cosmetics brand for \$800 million in cash and stock upfront, with another \$200 million contingent on future growth.

By Sandra E. Garcia



TELEVISION

Harry, Hermione and Ron Are Cast for HBO's 'Harry Potter'

After tens of thousands of auditions, three newcomers were selected to play the television show's leading roles.

By Derrick Bryson Taylor



STYLE

How These Little Elves Turned Into a Global Sensation

Online and in person, people are clamoring to get their hands on Labubu, which are dolls that are "well-intentioned" but somewhat mischievous.

By Alisha Haridasani Gupta

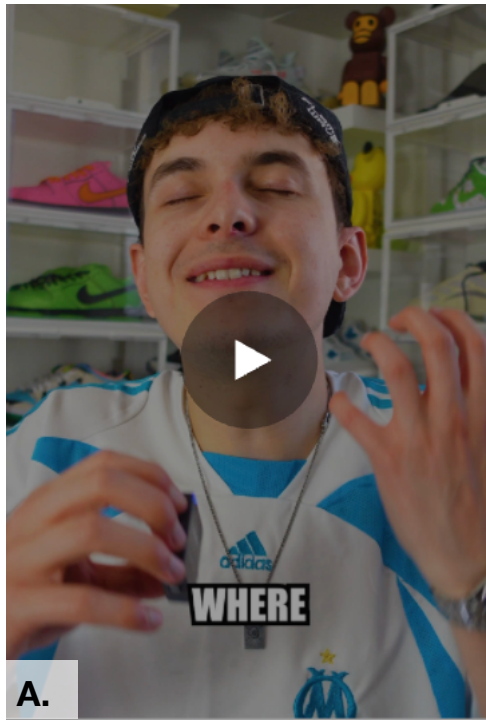


Exercise 2

You will each watch a different TikTok video:

- *Student A:* Labubu dolls
- *Student B:* Rhode skincare brand
- *Student C:* New Harry Potter series

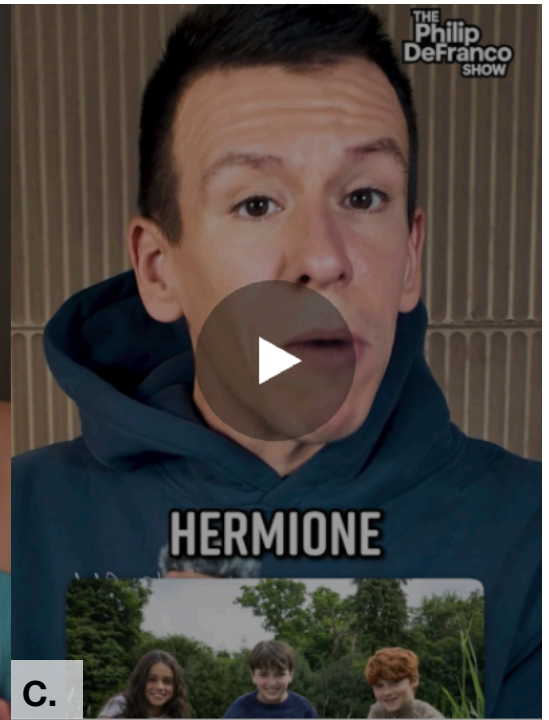
While you watch, complete the sentences below using ideas from the video. Use your own words.



A.



B.



C.

1a. Labubus got this popular mostly because...

1b. People are now buying them instead of...

2a. What's special about this deal is that...

2b. The brand makes more money than its many competitors because...

3a. People are feeling nervous for the new cast because...

3b. They are especially worried for the girl playing Hermione because...

Vocabulary Tip

'Retail' means selling products to individual people, usually in shops or online.

Compares to 'wholesale', which means selling large amounts of products, usually to shops or businesses.

Exercise 3

Work in groups of three. Take turns sharing what you learned from your TikTok video.

After each person shares, the other two group members should express their thoughts on the subject using some of the phrases below.

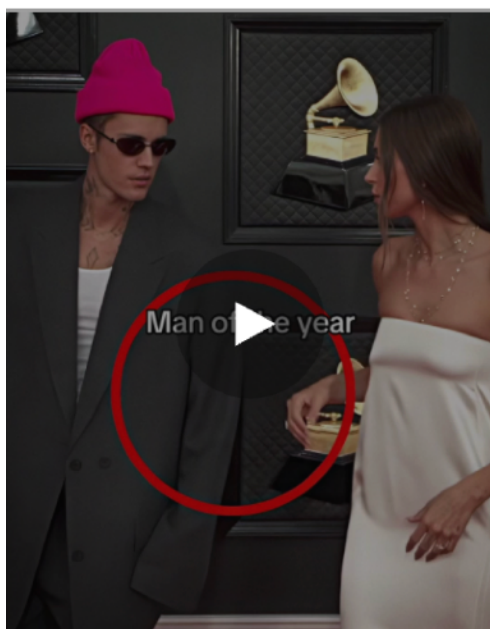
- I'm not gonna lie, I think...
- I've always thought that...
- I have a feeling that...
- From what I've heard, I can say...

- I might be wrong, but...
- The way I see it...
- I'm 100% sure that...
- In my experience...

Exercise 4

Watch the two videos about Justin and Hailey Bieber's relationship.

Then, read the statements below and discuss how far you agree or disagree with each one.



They're going through a rough patch after becoming parents – that's pretty normal for young couples.

Hailey often looks more supportive and emotionally present in their relationship than Justin does.

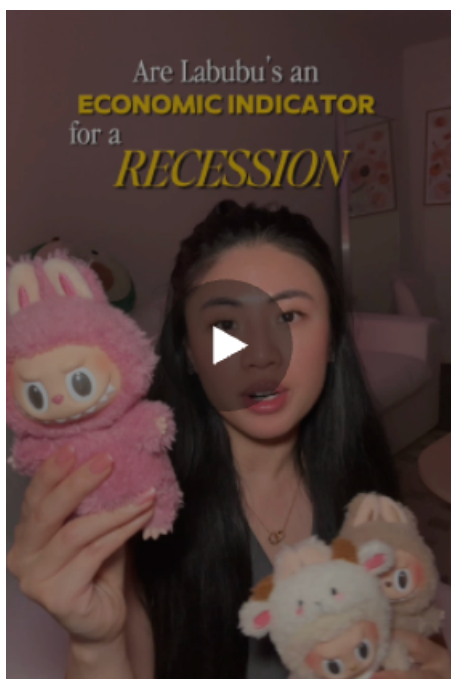
Hailey is the breadwinner, and that creates tension in their relationship.

People expect too much from celebrity couples – they're just human.

Exercise 5

"Labubus are an indicator for an economic recession" – why might this be true?

Watch the video and check your ideas.



Exercise 6

Discuss the following questions with your partner.

A.

What are some other “little luxuries” you or people you know buy when stressed or uncertain? Why those things?

B.

Have you noticed your spending habits change recently? What do you spend more/less money on these days?

C.

Do you think it's better to save during uncertain times, or to spend on things that make you feel better? Why?

Exercise 7

Watch the video explaining why some people dislike JK Rowling and summarize it in your own words.



Exercise 8

Read the statement below and decide whether you agree or disagree. Take a few minutes to think of arguments to support your opinion.

Then, share your views with your groupmates.

The art and the artist cannot be separated.